PROJECT PROPOSAL

A Centralized Digital Wedding Planning Platform for the Sri Lankan Market

Prepared for the Module: Project Management

Submitted by: Group 04

M.S. Ranasinghe	CIT-24-02-0189
S.A.A Lakmal	CIT-24-02-0007
V.G.Ruchira Nimnaka	CIT-24-02-0029
A.G.D.N Ranathunga	CIT-24-02-0046
K.A.R.D Sammani	CIT-24-02-0058

Project Duration: 12-Week Module Timeline (6-Week Core Development Sprint)

Document Version: 1.0

Date: 04 July 2026

Table of Contents

1. Project Title & Description

Project Title

MagulaPlan- A Centralized Digital Wedding Planning Platform for the Sri Lankan Market.

Background and context

The Sri Lankan wedding industry is highly active but digitally fragmented. Currently, couples must navigate a scattered mix of Facebook pages, Instagram profiles, and WhatsApp groups to find and compare vendors.

Purpose of the System: The main problem this platform solves is the massive time investment and manual effort required to plan a wedding locally. It eliminates the need for couples to manually track down vendor pricing, availability, and contact details across multiple disconnected social media apps.

Brief Overview of How it Works: MagulaPlan acts as a centralized digital marketplace. Users can filter wedding vendors by specific categories (e.g., photographers, venues, bridal wear) and districts. They can view vendor portfolios, compare packages, and use direct WhatsApp integration to contact vendors immediately.

Significance & Expected Impact: This system significantly benefits engaged couples by saving them weeks of manual planning and research time. It also provides local wedding vendors with a dedicated, professional online space to increase their visibility and manage customer inquiries efficiently.

2. Objectives & Scope

This section outlines the objectives of the Wedding Planning Platform and defines the scope of the project, including the core functionalities to be developed, optional features for future enhancement, and the limitations of the initial release.

A. Objectives

Over our six-week development sprint, we have set a few core goals to ensure we build a practical, usable platform. By the end of the project timeline, our team plans to:

- Develop a centralized web-based platform that enables couples to plan and manage their wedding activities efficiently.
- Provide a vendor directory containing at least six categories of wedding service providers with search and filtering capabilities.
- Develop a budget tracking feature that allows users to create budgets, record expenses, and monitor remaining balances.
- Implement a guest list and RSVP management system that enables users to organize guest information and track invitation responses.
- Enable users to generate and share digital wedding invitations through WhatsApp using invitation links.
- Deploy the completed Wedding Planning Platform as a responsive web application that is accessible online by the end of the project.

B. Scope

The scope of the Wedding Planning Platform defines the functionalities that will be included in the project as well as the features that will not be implemented during the initial development phase.

- **Core Functionalities**

The following core functionalities will be fully designed, developed, tested, and deployed as part of the project.

Core Functionality	Description
User Accounts & Dashboard	Allows couples to register, log in securely, and manage their wedding planning activities through a personalized dashboard.
Vendor Directory	Enables users to search and browse wedding vendors by category, location, and price range.
Budget Tracker	Allows users to create a wedding budget, record expenses, and monitor remaining balances.
Guest List & RSVP Manager	Enables users to manage guest information, send invitations, and track RSVP responses.
WhatsApp Digital Invitations	Allows users to generate digital invitation links and share invitations through WhatsApp.

Responsive Web Application	Deploys the completed platform as a live, responsive web application accessible through modern web browsers.

- **Optional / Advanced Features**

The following features are considered future enhancements and will not be included in the initial version of the project.

Optional Feature	Description
Native Mobile Application	Develop dedicated Android and iOS mobile applications.
AI-Based Vendor Recommendation	Recommend suitable vendors using artificial intelligence based on user preferences and previous selections.
Multi-Language Support	Support Sinhala and Tamil languages in addition to English.

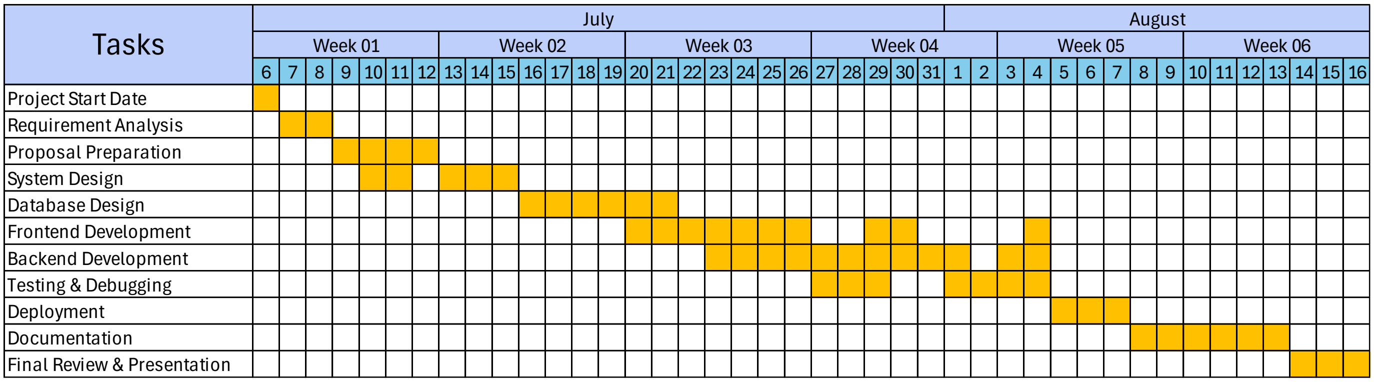
- **Limitations**

The following functionalities are outside the scope of this project.

Limitation	Description
Online Payment Gateway Integration	The platform will not process online payments or integrate with banking services. Users will manually record payments within the budget tracker.
Digital Contracts & E-Signatures	The platform will not support legally binding agreements or electronic signatures between couples and vendors.

3. Initial Timeline (Gantt Chart)

We have mapped out our entire 6-week module schedule below. The Gantt chart tracks our team's progress from the initial requirement gathering all the way to the final review and presentation.



The Gantt chart shows the schedule and task allocation for our project. The project starts with requirement analysis and proposal preparation.

The development phase will be the parallel implementation of frontend and backend to optimize the time. Once the system is developed, it is tested and debugged to ensure that it works and is reliable. It also going parallel with front end and back-end development.

The deployment is then carried out and then the documentation phase is started, in which the final report is compiled. The project ends with the handover of the project. With a structured timeline, the project is completed effectively within the given time.

4. Team Roles & Responsibilities

The five-member team is organized around clearly defined, complementary roles that map directly onto the platform's core modules, ensuring accountable ownership of each deliverable while preserving the cross-functional collaboration a 6-week build requires. All members contribute to code review and daily stand-ups regardless of primary role, reducing single points of failure (see Risk R2 in Section 8).

Full Name	**Student ID**	**Assigned Role**	**Specific Responsibilities**
Maheen Sayuru	CIT-24-02-0189	Project Manager	Coordinates the overall project, owns the initial timeline (Gantt chart), handles stakeholder communication,

			and compiles final documentation.
Dileepa Ranathunga	CIT-24-02-0046	UI/UX Designer & Frontend Developer	Implements the client interface in React/Tailwind, ensuring a responsive design for the vendor directory and user dashboards.
Amanda Lakmal	CIT-24-02-0007	Backend Developer	Designs the REST API (Java, Spring Boot), handles system authentication (Spring Security / JWT), and integrates WhatsApp routing logic.
K.A.R.D. Sammani	CIT-24-02-0058	Business Analyst & Database Engineer	Gathers system requirements, designs the MySQL database schema, and handles cloud deployment (Vercel/Render).
Ruchira Nimnaka	CIT-24-02-0029	QA Engineer	Authors the test plan, executes system testing, manages the defect log, and ensures the final

			MVP functions properly.

Appendix

Appendix A: Problem Statement & Market Need

Sri Lanka's wedding industry plays a major cultural role and generates significant economic activity throughout the year. Despite this, very little of it has moved online at the point where couples are actually planning and coordinating their weddings. The issues outlined below were identified through an analysis of the current practice of wedding planning in Sri Lanka and have been used to guide the scope of MagulaPlan.

Fragmented, Informal Vendor Discovery

Wedding vendors with photography and videography skills, decorators, caterers, bridal-wear specialists, musical bands and DJs, wedding-car hire services, poruwa specialists, astrologers who find the auspicious time (nekath) for the ceremony, and invitation card printers market themselves nearly exclusively through individual Facebook business pages, Instagram reels, and WhatsApp Business catalogues.

Currently, there is no single platform where couples can search, compare, and filter vendors by category, location, and price in Sri Lanka. When couples are trying to create their shortlist, they typically rely on recommendations from other people, look through Facebook wedding groups, or attend bridal expos in person.

Since there is no public pricing, a couple has to send a separate private message or make a phone call to each vendor just to get a quote, which makes the time commitment much greater.

Manual, Error-Prone Budget Management

There is no existing tool that reflects the actual financial structure of a Sri Lankan wedding: LKR-based budget line items, the deposit-and-balance payment schedules most local vendors expect, and cost breakdowns that span the three separate stages of the wedding, namely the registration, the homecoming, and the main ceremony.

Most couples currently track their spending using paper notebooks or generic spreadsheets. Because these are not shared in real time between partners and family members, this often leads to duplicated entries, conflicting versions, and delayed visibility into overspending.

There is also no automated alert when a category, such as catering or decor, approaches or exceeds its allocated budget. As a result, overspending is often only discovered after the payment has already been made.

Disconnected Guest List and RSVP Coordination

Sri Lankan weddings typically involve very large guest lists, often several hundred people spanning multiple generations of both families. Managing RSVPs for a list this size is still handled almost entirely through individual phone calls or one-on-one WhatsApp messages. Not only does this consume a significant amount of planning time, it also means no one ever has a single, reliable headcount at any given moment.

This becomes a real operational problem closer to the event date, since caterers and venues typically require confirmed attendance numbers in advance. At present, couples have no centralized system to track live RSVP status, side-of-family breakdowns, or meal preferences. Everything has to be cross-checked manually against scattered phone and message records.

On top of this, there is no lightweight, locally relevant seating or table assignment tool to help manage the seating arrangements common at large Sri Lankan wedding receptions.

No Localized End-to-End Digital Invitation Channel

WhatsApp is by far the most widely used communication channel in Sri Lanka for both personal and business purposes, relied on more heavily than SMS or email for informal and semi-formal coordination, including wedding planning.

Despite this, no wedding platform focused on the Sri Lankan market currently allows a couple to generate a digital invitation and distribute it directly to an entire guest list through WhatsApp, complete with an embedded RSVP link. As a result, most couples continue to rely on printed invitations by default. These are not only more expensive and slower to produce, but also offer no way to digitally track delivery or RSVP responses once sent out.

The Market Gap

Well-known global platforms like The Knot, Zola, and WeddingWire were built around U.S. and European weddings, and this shows in how they're structured - their vendors, their pricing, even their planning steps all assume a market that isn't Sri Lanka's. They also don't account for the multi-day, multi-religious ceremonies common here, whether Sinhalese Buddhist, Tamil Hindu, Muslim, or Christian/Burgher, nor do they reflect how Sri Lankan vendors are categorized or how heavily WhatsApp is used for coordination.

What this leaves is a real, unaddressed gap: a single, locally relevant digital ecosystem that treats vendor search, budgeting, guest management, and invitation delivery as one connected workflow instead of four separate manual processes. MagulaPlan is built to fill exactly that gap.

Appendix B: Project Deliverables

Below is a complete breakdown of all the required materials, documentation, and technical components our team will submit over our fast-paced 6-week module.

Deliverable	Description	Format	Target Week
Project Proposal	The initial planning document outlining the problem, objectives, scope, and timeline (this document).	Word Document (.docx)	Week 1
Project Management Plan	A clear breakdown of our team's tasks, sprint schedules, and how we are dividing the workload.	Word Document / Gantt Chart	Week 2
System Design & Architecture	The technical blueprints for the app, including database diagrams (ERD), API routes, and UI wireframes.	pdf / Diagrams	Week 2
Sprint Progress Reports	Regular, short updates submitted to show our development progress and highlight any challenges we are facing.	Written Reports	Weeks 2-5
Testing Documentation	A record of our test cases (unit and user acceptance testing) and a log showing how we fixed major bugs.	Word Document / Excel	Week 5
Final Source Code	The complete, working codebase for the frontend, backend, and database, properly version-controlled.	GitHub Repository	Week 6
Live System Demonstration	Presenting the fully functional, hosted web application end-to-end for the final grading..	Live Web Application	Week 6
Final Project Report	A wrap-up document reflecting on the overall project, our teamwork, and the lessons we learned.	Word Document	Week 6

Appendix C: High-Level Risk Management

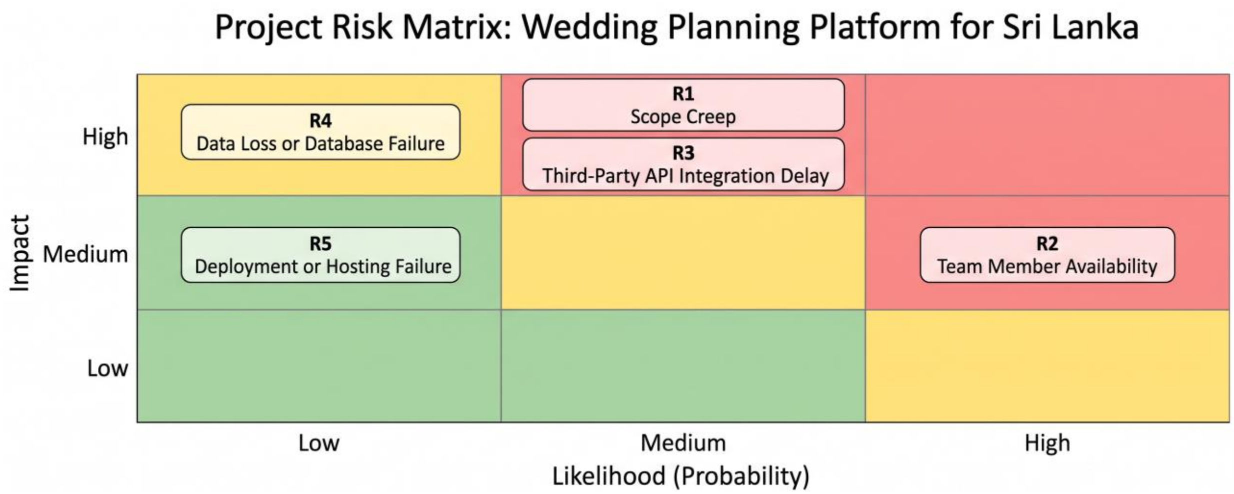
Risk management is an important aspect of project management that helps in the identification, evaluation and control of possible risks which may impact on the successful completion of a project. As the Wedding Planning Platform will be developed within a six-week development period, early identification of possible risks allows the project team to take appropriate preventive actions. Risks will be monitored throughout the project and mitigation strategies will be developed and employed to minimize the impact of risks on the project schedule, quality and overall success.

Risk Assessment

The following table identifies the major risks that may affect the successful completion of the project. Each risk has been evaluated according to its probability of occurrence, expected impact on the project, and overall risk level.

RISK ID	**Risk**	Probability	**Impact**	**Risk Level**
R1	Scope Creep vs. the 'Fully Functional' Requirement	Medium	High	High
R2	Student Team Availability Conflicts	High	Medium	High
R3	Third-Party WhatsApp Integration Delays	Medium	High	High
R4	Data Loss or Database Failure	Low	High	Medium
R5	Deployment or Hosting Failure	Low	Medium	Low

Risk Matrix



Risk Legend

- **R1** - Scope Creep: Description: Adding features beyond the agreed project scope may delay the completion of core modules.
- **R2** - Team Member Availability: Description: Team members may have examinations, assignment deadlines, or personal commitments
- that reduce development time.
- **R3**- Third-Party API Integration Delay: Description: Integration with the WhatsApp Business API may be delayed because of approval
- processes or technical limitations.
- **R4** - Data Loss or Database Failure: Description: Database failures or accidental data deletion could affect project data and testing.
- **R5** - Deployment or Hosting Failure: Description: Cloud deployment or hosting issues may delay the final system demonstration.

Risk Response Plan

ID	Description	Mitigation Strategy	Contingency Plan

R1	The project requirement to deliver a fully functional Wedding Planning Platform within a six-week development period may encourage the team to add features beyond the agreed scope, resulting in delays and incomplete implementation of core functionalities.	Lock the four core modules (Vendor Directory, Budget Tracker, Guest/RSVP Manager, WhatsApp Invitations) as fixed must-haves using MoSCoW prioritization at the Planning phase; defer any additional feature request to a documented backlog; the Project Manager reviews scope against the WBS at every weekly stand-up and rejects unplanned additions during the 6-week execution phase.	Remove or postpone non-essential features and focus only on core modules if the project falls behind schedule.
R2	Team members may experience competing academic deadlines, examinations, or personal commitments during the six-week development period, which could affect project progress and task completion.	Allocate tasks evenly, maintain shared documentation using GitHub, conduct weekly progress meetings, and redistribute tasks whenever necessary to maintain project progress.	Redistribute unfinished tasks among available members and adjust priorities to complete critical features.
R3	Integration with the WhatsApp Business API may be delayed due to API approval processes, configuration issues, or technical limitations, affecting the implementation of the digital invitation feature.	Begin API integration during the early stages of development and use WhatsApp Click-to-Chat as an alternative solution if API approval is delayed or unavailable.	Continue using the backup Click-to-Chat solution until API access is available or technical problems are resolved.
R4	Unexpected database failures, accidental data deletion, or software errors may result in the loss of important project data, affecting system reliability and testing activities.	Perform regular database backups, use GitHub version control, and implement database recovery procedures to ensure important data can be restored quickly.	Restore the latest database backup and recover the application using the GitHub repository.

R5	Technical issues during cloud deployment or server configuration may prevent the application from being successfully deployed before the final demonstration.	Perform deployment testing before the final submission, verify server configurations, and prepare an alternative cloud hosting platform as a backup deployment solution.	Deploy the application using an alternative cloud hosting service if the primary deployment fails.

Risk Monitoring

Risk management will be an ongoing process throughout the six-week development period. During the weekly project meetings, the Project Manager will review the risk register, evaluate the status of existing risks, identify any newly emerging risks, and ensure that mitigation strategies are implemented effectively. High-priority risks will be addressed immediately to minimize their impact on the project schedule, budget, and overall system quality.